

In the summer of 2016, I heard Brad as a guest on the *Mad Fientist* podcast talking about credit card travel rewards. When I found out he lived in Richmond, VA, I reached out to see if he wanted to get lunch. My enthusiasm got the best of me and a fun conversation on pursuing FI and maximizing travel rewards morphed into an idea to start and collaborate on a blog and companion podcast. The concepts brought together by this community are powerful enough to start a movement. While it's difficult to have a blog or podcast be linear, especially when you are learning as you go, this book represents our best effort to distill those transformative ideas into a Blueprint to FI.

This book features stories of people who have achieved or are on the path to FI. On the podcast, Brad often says FI is like a superpower that makes life easier. However, there are no Clark Kents or Peter Parkers in this book. No one in this book is from the planet Krypton, and no one was bitten by a radioactive spider.

This book is filled with stories of ordinary people from all walks of life. You will read about people from rural areas with low costs of living and high-cost big cities, from an assortment of careers ranging from physicians and hedge fund managers to school teachers and